The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa That Completely Purifies All Bad Destinies

Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhanī-uṣṇīṣavijayā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 984 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དན་འགྲོ་སྤྱོམས་ཙད་ཡངོས་སུསྒྲུབ་པ་གཙུག་ཏོར་རྣམ་པར་རྒྱལ་བ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa That Completely Purifies All Bad Destinies, known in Sanskrit as the Āryasarvadurgatipariśodhanī Uṣṇīṣavijayā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Ngendro Tamche Yongsu Jongwa Tsuktor Nampar Gyalwa Zhejawai Zung, is a dhāraṇī scripture centered on the protective and purifying power of the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa incantation. Its narrative opens in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, where the young god Supratiṣṭhita, while enjoying celestial pleasures, hears a voice in the night warning that he will die in seven days and then pass through a series of unfortunate rebirths in the human world and beyond. This dire prophecy sets the stage for the revelation of the dhāraṇī as a means of averting such fates, purifying negative karma, and freeing beings from rebirth in the lower realms. The work is Toh 984 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collections of sacred spells and incantations valued throughout the Buddhist world for protection, purification, and the welfare of the living and the dead.

In the language of India: ārya sarva durga ti pa ri śo dha ni uṣṣī ṣa bi ja ya nā ma dhā ra ṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa That Completely Purifies All Bad Destinies.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

At that time a son of the gods called Supratiṣṭhita was dwelling among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods. In a great celestial palace, surrounded by great divine riches and by a great host of goddesses, he was playing, enjoying himself and delighting. While he was enjoying those divine pleasures, he heard a voice in the night: "The son of the gods Supratiṣṭhita will die on the seventh day. Once he has died, he will be born in Jambudvīpa, and there he will undergo seven destinies. After undergoing the seven destinies, he will be born in the hells. And if, one time in a hundred, he should be born as a human, he will be poor there, and born blind." This is what he heard.

When that son of the gods heard this voice, he was terrified, frightened and appalled, and his hair stood on end. In great haste he went to where Śakra, the lord of the gods, was. Having arrived, he bowed at the feet of Śakra, the lord of the gods, and, speaking hurriedly and wailing "Alas! Alas!", he said this to Śakra, the lord of the gods:

"Lord of the gods, please listen. Lord of the gods, today, while I was surrounded by a host of goddesses, playing with the joy of divine riches and experiencing happiness, I heard a voice: 'The son of the gods Supratiṣṭhita will die in seven days and will be born in Jambudvīpa. There he will undergo seven destinies, and after that he will be born in the hells. And if, one time in a hundred, he should be born as a human, he will be poor there, and born blind.' Since I have heard this, lord of the gods, what am I to do about it?"

When Śakra, the lord of the gods, heard these words of the son of the gods Supratiṣṭhita, he was deeply astonished. Thinking, "What are the seven destinies this son of the gods will undergo?", he sat in silence, and he saw the seven destinies: birth as a pig, a dog, a fox, a monkey, a venomous snake, a vulture and a crow. He saw that in those seven destinies he would have to eat the foulest filth.

Then, having seen those seven destinies, Śakra, the lord of the gods, thought: "Alas! This son of the gods is going to undergo great and unbearable suffering. Apart from the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who could become his refuge, his support and his ally?"

Then, in the first part of that night, Śakra, the lord of the gods, took perfumes, flowers, various incenses, garments, various ornaments and so forth, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him seven times, sat down before the Blessed One, and described to the Blessed One in detail the seven destinies of the son of the gods Supratiṣṭhita.

As soon as Śakra, the lord of the gods, had described those seven destinies, rays of light of many kinds came forth from the Blessed One's uṣṇīṣa. They illuminated every place in the world systems of the ten directions, and then returned and entered the Blessed One's mouth. Then the Blessed One smiled and said this to Śakra, the lord of the gods:

"Lord of the gods, there is the dhāraṇī called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa, which the Tathāgata confers as empowerment at the crown of the head. It completely purifies all bad destinies; it destroys all obscurations and all births in suffering;

it completely purifies the hells, the animal realm and the entire world of Yama; and it establishes beings on the path to the higher destinies.

"Therefore, lord of the gods, as soon as one hears this dhāraṇī called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa, which completely purifies all bad destinies, the very many and various forms of suffering that would become obscurations are destroyed. One will obtain a continuum of completely pure births. In all one's lives one will remember one's former lives. One will go from buddha field to buddha field. One will go from heaven to heaven, as far as the thirty-two abodes of the gods.

"Lord of the gods, as soon as it is recited, even one whose life is exhausted will obtain the karma by which life is prolonged. Having accumulated completely pure actions of body, speech and mind, one will dwell in a state of comfort. All the tathāgatas will look upon such a person, and they will constantly and unceasingly guard, protect and shelter that person. All the bodhisattvas, too, will keep that person in mind.

"By merely reciting it, the hells, the animal realm, the world of Yama and all the domains of the hungry ghosts will be dried up, destroyed, scattered, cleared away and emptied. In this way the doors of all the buddha fields, all the abodes of the gods and all the abodes of the bodhisattvas will be opened for that person, and that person will enter wherever he wishes."

Then Śakra, the lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please pronounce that dhāraṇī. Please teach what will nourish the life of all sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the request made by Śakra, the lord of the gods, spoke these dhāraṇī words:

oṃ namo bhagavate sarva trailokya prati viṣaṣṭīya buddhāya te namaḥ tadyathā oṃ bhrūṃ bhrūṃ bhrūṃ śodhaya śodhaya viśodhaya viśodhaya asamasamanta avabhāsa spharaṇa gati gagana svabhāva viśuddhe uṣṇīṣa vijaya pariśuddhe abhiṣiñcantu māṃ sarva tathāgata sugata vara vācana amṛta abhiṣekaira mahāmudra manha padaiḥ āhara āhara mama āyuḥ sandharaṇi śodhaya śodhaya viśodhraya viśodhaya gagana svabhāva viśuddhe uṣṇīṣa vijaya bariśuddhe sahasra rasmis ñcodite sarva tathāgata avalokini ṣaṭ pāramitā paripūraṇi sarva tethāgatā māte daśa bhūmi bratiṣṭhite sarva tathāgatā hṛdaya adhiṣṣāna adhiṣṭhite mudre mudre mahāmudre vajra kāya saṃhatina pariśuddhe sarva karma āvaraṇa viśuddhe pratinivartaya mama āyura viśuddhe sarva tathāgatā samaya adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite oṃ

mune muni mahāmune vimuni vimuni mahāvimuni mati mati mahāmati mamati sumati tathātā bhūtakoṭi pariśuddhe visphuṭa buddhe śuddhe he he jaya jaya vijaya vijaya smara smara sphara sphara sphāraya sphāraya sarva buddha adhiṣṭhana adhiṣṭhite śuddhe śuddhe buddhe buddhe vajre vajre mahāvajre suvajre vajragarbhe jayagarbhe vijayagarbhe vajrajvālagarbhe vajra udbhave vajra saṃbhave vajre vajriṇi vajrembhavatu mama śarīraṃ sarva satvānāñca kāya pariśuddhir bhavatu madā me sarva gati pariśuddhiśca sarva tathāgatasmaya adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite sarva tathāgatāśca māṃ samāsvāsayantu buddha buddha siddhya siddhya bodhaya bodhaya vibodhaya vibodhaya mocaya mocaya vimocaya vimecaya śodhaya śodhaya viśodhaya viśodhaya samantana mocaya mocaya samanta rasmi pariśuddhe sarva tathāgatā hṛdaya adhiṣṭhana adhiṣṭhite mudre mudre mahāmudre mahāmudrā mantra padaiḥ svāhā

"Lord of the gods, this dhāraṇī called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa, which purifies all bad destinies, which thoroughly purifies all evil, karma and obscurations, which causes one to go along all the paths of the happy destinies and destroys all the bad destinies, has been spoken by buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in eighty-eight hundred thousand koṭis of Ganges rivers. They have blessed it and rejoiced in it, and it is sealed with the seal of the wisdom of all the tathāgatas. It was spoken in order to cause all sentient beings to go to the happy destinies, to turn back those falling into the bad destinies, and to liberate those who suffer and are in distress in all the places of suffering, such as the hells, the animal births and the world of Yama, and the beings who have fallen into the ocean of suffering. Likewise, for the sake of beings who are short-lived and of little fortune, who are despised, whose intentions have degenerated, and who have fallen from the path, this dhāraṇī is established in Jambudvīpa.

"Lord of the gods, take up this dhāraṇī and proclaim it to the young god Supratiṣṭhita. And having proclaimed it, set him to reciting it, memorizing it, reflecting on it, meditating on it, keeping it in mind, worshipping it, retaining it and mastering it. In this way, for the welfare, benefit and happiness of the young gods dwelling in all the abodes of the gods and of the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa, I entrust to you the mudrā of this dhāraṇī and these secret mantras. Therefore, lord of the gods, you should hold it.

"Lord of the gods, as soon as one hears this dhāraṇī, the obscurations of karma accumulated over a hundred thousand eons will be completely purified. It should be known that, in birth after birth, one will never again be born in any

of the various kinds of births: among the hells, the animal births, the world of Yama, the domain of the hungry ghosts, or the class of asuras, nor among yakṣas, rākṣasas, bhūtas, piśācas, pūtanas, kaṭapūtanas, apasmāras, dogs, tortoises, snakes, fierce beasts of prey, birds, flies, bees, scorpions, ants and beetles, or any other kind of creature. Apart from that, there will be nothing but meeting the tathāgatas and being born into the family of the bodhisattvas. I declare that such a one will be born into great families: a brahmin family like a great sāla tree, a royal family like a great sāla tree, or a merchant family like a great sāla tree.

"Lord of the gods, thus by the power of this dhāraṇī, until finally reaching the heart of awakening, one attains a great purity of birth. Lord of the gods, this dhāraṇī is that powerful. Lord of the gods, this dhāraṇī is that powerful, of great benefit, of great might, virtuous and auspicious. Lord of the gods, for the sake of sentient beings I have established this dhāraṇī called the Victorious Uṣṇīṣa, which purifies all bad destinies.

"It is like this: just as the precious jewel Sūryagarbha, utterly stainless, completely pure like space, and luminous, abides blazing with the radiance of its rays of light, so too, lord of the gods, that being should be known to be undefiled. It is like this: just as the gold of the Jambū river is stainless, utterly pure, exceedingly soft and exceedingly lovely, so too, lord of the gods, that being should be understood to be utterly pure, and in other lives too he will be born in the same way.

"Lord of the gods, wherever this dhāraṇī is taught, and in particular wherever people have it written down, hold it, read it, recite it, memorize it, worship it, master it, listen to it and retain it, there all destinies will be completely purified, and all the hells will be cut off.

"Lord of the gods, this dhāraṇī should be written down and placed at the top of a victory banner. It should be placed on a high mountain, on a tall building, or upon the central pole of a stupa.

Lord of the gods, a monk, a nun, a layman, a laywoman, or any other son or daughter of good family may see it placed on top of a banner, or come to be near it, or even be touched by its shadow, or be touched by dust blown from it by the wind. Lord of the gods, for that being no wrongdoing will arise, and none of the fears of going to the lower realms. They will not be born in the hells, in the animal realm, in the world of Yama, among the hungry ghosts, or in any of the classes of asuras. Lord of the gods, that being should be known

as one prophesied by all the tathāgatas, and as irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Lord of the gods, then what need is there to speak of those who make offerings and pay homage, who adorn it with flowers, incense, fragrances, garlands, ointments, parasols, banners, flags, fragrances and ornaments, who build a stupa at a crossroads and place this dhāraṇī in it, and who join their palms to it, prostrate to it, or circumambulate it? Lord of the gods, such a being should be known as a great being. They should be known as a child of the tathāgatas. They should be known as an abode of the Dharma. They should be known as a stupa of the tathāgatas.

Then, when the night had passed and dawn had come, Yama, the King of Dharma, went to where the Blessed One was. He made offerings to the Blessed One and honored him with divine flowers, garments, ornaments and so forth. He circumambulated the Blessed One seven times, touched his head to the Blessed One's feet, and said these words: "Blessed One, this dhāraṇī is of great power and great benefit. Blessed One, I too shall constantly and without interruption follow after that being, and remain at hand to guard them and protect them completely. I shall turn them back from all the hells. Blessed One, I am grateful for what has been done, and I am not ungrateful for what has been done."

Then the Four Great Kings circumambulated the Blessed One three times and said these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please explain in detail the precise rite of this dhāraṇī and the method of the procedure to be performed."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the Four Great Kings: "Listen, and I shall explain the method of practice for this dhāraṇī. For the sake of a being whose life is short, a son or daughter of good family should bathe on the fifteenth day, the day of the full moon, and recite it one thousand and eight times. By this, the life of that being whose lifespan is exhausted will be extended, and they will become free of all illness. They will attain the complete purification of all obscurations. They will be completely liberated from all the lower realms, the hells and the rest. One should proclaim the sound of this dhāraṇī even into the ear of a bird, a creature that has gone to the animal realm; it should be known that by this, that is its last rebirth in the lower realms.

Whoever is struck by a great illness and has been diagnosed by physicians will also be completely freed from that illness. All their rebirths in the lower realms

will also be cut off. After dying and passing on, they will be born in the world realm of Sukhāvatī. That should be known as their final dwelling in a womb. Wherever they are born, there they will be born miraculously, solely from the heart of a lotus. In all their lifetimes they will remember their past lives.

For the sake of beings who did evil and have died, one should recite the dhāraṇī twenty-one times over white mustard seeds and scatter them over their bones. Then, even if they have been born in the hells, the animal realm, the world of Yama, among the hungry ghosts, or in other lower realms, by the power of this dhāraṇī they will be freed from those lower realms. Once freed from them, they will be born among the gods.

Whoever recites this twenty-one times each day will become worthy of the offerings of many worlds. They will be long-lived. They will experience happiness. They will always be joyful, and they will attain great nirvāṇa. After dying and passing on, they will be born in the world realm of Sukhāvatī. From there they will go to many different buddha fields. There they will meet all the tathāgatas, all the tathāgatas will console them, and all the tathāgatas will prophesy their awakening. In all the buddha fields they will bring light to the world.

Lord of the gods, by this method all beings will be completely liberated from every destiny, the hells and the rest. All their destinies will be purified, and they will also become long-lived. Lord of the gods, go and teach and proclaim this dhāraṇī to the god's son Supratiṣṭhitamati. Lord of the gods, by this, within seven days all the destinies of the god's son Supratiṣṭhita will be purified, and he will become long-lived. He will become greatly powerful."

Then Śakra, the lord of the gods, received this instruction from the Tathāgata, went to his own abode, and gave this dhāraṇī to the god's son Supratiṣṭhita. Then that god's son applied himself to this dhāraṇī for six days and six nights, until the seventh day, and all his wishes were fulfilled. He was completely freed from the lower realms, he abided on the path of the higher realms, and he became long-lived. And he uttered this inspired utterance: "How wonderful the Buddha! How wonderful the Dharma! How wonderful that such a dhāraṇī as this has appeared in the world, through which I have been completely freed from great fear!"

This completes the noble dhāraṇī called The Victorious Uṣṇīṣa That Completely Purifies All Lower Realms.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Surendrabodhi and the chief editor and translator Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• "The thirty-two abodes of the gods" follows the Tibetan as written, though the heaven is elsewhere called that of the Thirty-Three. "Nourish the life" renders an idiom that literally means "apply medicine to the life," that is, to benefit or sustain the life of beings.
• The jewel name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Sūryagarbha, its usual Sanskrit equivalent. The spirit classes □□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□ are given as pūtana, kaṭapūtana and apasmāra, their standard equivalents.
• In one place the Tibetan calls the god's son "Supratiṣṭhitamati" (adding "intelligence" to his name); it refers to the same figure elsewhere called Supratiṣṭhita. The phrase rendered "diagnosed by physicians" literally means "distinguished" or "examined" by physicians.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.